

Goal-Setting System Transcript



Name: Sarah	Height: 5'5"
Age: 26	Body fat: 28%
Weight: 145	
Planning and Education	
Gather Information	
Sarah: Hello, I'm a new member here (at the gym); I was wondering if there was a personal trainer I could speak with today. Receptionist: Yes, give me a moment and I will call up Winston, one of our certified personal trainers. Winston: Hi, my name is Winston; it's nice to meet you. I want to sit down first and get some information about what you are looking to accomplish here at the gym. Sarah: Well, I've wanted to get in shape for a long time now, but I've been lacking the motivation to take charge myself. It's hard when you get off of work and just want to relax for a few minutes; next thing you know, more than a few minutes have gone by and it's time for bed! Winston: Have you ever belonged to a gym before? Sarah: I had a membership about four years ago but I never really used it, so I could almost say no. It's been a while since I really worked out hard. I participated in sports a lot in school, from elementary to high school, so I'm no stranger to hard work, but it has definitely been a while. Winston: Four years may have been a while, but it's great that you're here today. What made you take the big step of getting the membership? Sarah: I recently got engaged and started trying on wedding dresses. I didn't like what I saw and really was negative about the whole process. This is honestly the heaviest I have ever been. Winston: Congratulations on your engagement! Tell me what you didn't like about what you saw when you were trying on the dresses. Sarah: I just don't think I looked my best. Mainly, I want to lose weight and get toned, especially in my arms, shoulders, and back. I want to get a strapless dress and look great in it. Winston: I'm sorry to hear you had an unpleasant experience trying on wedding dresses. What drove you to look into personal training?	

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Sarah: I just know that I need help and need to be pushed. I have always had a hard time pushing myself.

Winston: That's very understandable. Do you know what weight or body fat percentage you were at when you liked the way your arms looked before?

Sarah: I think I was about 130 but I never had my body fat tested before.

Winston: What has prevented you from getting back to your ideal weight?

Sarah: Honestly, I have just not had the motivation. I go home from work, sit down, and relax, and once I do that, it's really hard to get back out and go to the gym.

Winston: When you liked the way you looked before, what were you doing to keep yourself that way?

Sarah: I did some workout videos and I would force myself to walk during the day. That might not seem like much, but it seemed that was all I had to do.

Winston: Do you have a goal in mind for your walks, such as distance or time?

Sarah: My goal is mainly that I just get up at least once a day and walk around for a little while.

Winston: What do you do for work?

Sarah: I'm an accountant.

Winston: Do you currently follow a diet plan?

Sarah: No, but I try to watch what I eat.

Winston: How do you watch what you eat?

Sarah: I try to get in vegetables as often as I can and try not to eat out too much.

Winston: Do you keep a nutrition log?

Sarah: Nope!

Winston: If you had to choose, what would be more important to you, the amount of weight you lose or your dress size?

Sarah: I think I would be more concerned about my dress size.

Winston: If you had to rate your present level of commitment to achieve your goals on a scale of 1 to 10, with 1 being the least committed and 10 being the most committed, where would you put yourself?

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Sarah: I would be a 10. I have a huge day coming up; I want to look my best. I will do whatever it takes to get there.

Winston: Which kinds of barriers do you think might affect your ability to work out and eat right?

Sarah: The snacks and junk food that are always at work are a constant temptation. Normally I would say that my work schedule is a factor, but I will make sure that it does not become a factor in the next 6 months.

Work on Making Goals Specific

Winston: I am very excited to help you achieve your fitness goals. You said that the dress size to you is more important than the weight, so what dress size are you hoping to fit into and if you had to guess, what weight would that be?

Sarah: I would like to be a size 2. I'm currently a size 10 and 145 pounds, but I think I will look good at 110. My wedding is in 6 months, but my final dress fitting will be 2 weeks prior to the big day.

Educate Client on How to Set Goals

Winston: That's a great start. I have here some information on goal setting I'd like you to take home and review before our next meeting. This information will discuss the importance of making your goals measurable, writing them down, and reevaluating them if necessary. When you know the basic principles of goal setting, it will help you to create quality goals and stick to them. Additionally, people who set goals this way are more likely to achieve their goals.

Have Client Develop Several Goals

Winston: Once you have reviewed this information, review your fitness goals and think about making them more specific. After you have settled on some specific goals, write them down and bring them to our next meeting so we can look them over along with the ones I will create for you.

Setting Goals (Meeting Stage)

Review Client Goals (Goals Made by the Client)

Winston: Hi, Sarah, it's nice to see you again. Did you review the goal-setting information and come up with a few specific goals?

Sarah: Yes, after thinking about my goals and making sure they are realistic, I think a size 2 might be a little too ambitious. I would like to be down from a size 10 to a size 4 in 5 months.

Review Professional Goals (Goals Made by the Trainer)

Winston: Great, let me go over the goals I have set for you. First off, I think that 110 pounds is a bit low for what you are striving for and is technically considered slightly underweight. You may not have had

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much muscle when you were that size. Additionally, I think you will like the way you look if we can get you to 125. What are your thoughts on that?

Sarah: I suppose we can start there.

Winston: Great. I also think you can lose 1 pound of body fat per week, so I would like to set that as your short-term, weekly goal. To accomplish 1 pound of weight loss per week, we need to make sure you are eating less or moving more, or doing both. There are 3,500 calories in 1 pound of body fat, so essentially you need to eat 250 calories less per day and burn 250 calories more per day. Keep in mind that everyone's weight fluctuates from day to day due to fluid levels, hormone balance, and overall health status. But this is a good guide and will help keep you on track. Does this make sense so far?

Sarah: I think so, yes. So how do I know if that is happening?

Winston: We can start by saying you need to keep a nutrition log—either electronically or handwritten. Make sure you measure and document all foods that you eat. That will give us a starting point in terms of how many calories you should be eating.

Evaluation Stage

Goal Evaluation/Reevaluation

Winston: Hi, Sarah, so we have been working together for one full month now, which means we have 4 more months to go to reach your goals. Currently, you have lost 2 pounds. Tell me how you are feeling with your goals.

Sarah: I am not feeling really good about reaching my goal of losing 25 pounds in time for my wedding, but I do feel pretty good about some of the changes in my body. I feel stronger and less flabby, so that's good.

Winston: Let's pause for a moment to take some measurements and compare them with your initial measurements. It looks like you have lost 1 inch around your waist and $\frac{3}{4}$ inch on each thigh. Additionally, you have lost about $\frac{1}{2}$ inch on each arm, and your body fat has gone down 1%. You are definitely making progress.

Sarah: That's a relief.

Winston: Let's take a minute to reevaluate your goals. You originally wanted to lose 35 pounds to get down to 110 and fit into a size 2 dress. After reflecting, you decided it would be more realistic to aim for a size 4 dress, and we agreed that it would be a better goal to get you down to 125 pounds rather than 110 pounds. We set a goal to have you lose 1 pound per week. The first week, you lost 2 pounds. The second week, you lost 1 pound. In the third week, your weight did not change, and in this last week, you gained back a pound. For you to meet your weight goal by your specified date, you will need to lose about 1.5 pounds per week. Do you think that is still doable?

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Sarah: Honestly, no. I like the way my body is changing, but I think that I might need to change my weight goal. I also think that going all the way down to a size 4 might not work out either, I'm thinking a size 6 would be a little more realistic in the time remaining.

Winston: I agree. Let's change your weight goal to 130 pounds and your dress size goal to a size 6. We will still continue for the goal of a weight loss of 1 pound per week. Tell me, what are you doing for your cardio on the days you are not working out with me?